



Chicken

Preserved by: frozen

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

CHICKEN

FRESH



1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen



up to 12 months frozen at 0°F

Wow: Frozen chicken can last up to 12 months with good quality, far longer than just a couple of days fresh.

Safety: Store frozen chicken at 0°F (-18°C) or below to maintain safety and quality.



Winter squash (Butternut)

Preserved by: stored cured, cool and dry

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

WINTER SQUASH (BUTTERNUT)

FRESH



2-3 months stored at 50-55°F

PRESERVED — stored cured, cool and dry



6-12 months dried or canned

Wow: Properly cured winter squash lasts months unrefrigerated, often longer than canned or frozen versions kept improperly.

Safety: Store squash in dry, well-ventilated area away from ripening fruit to avoid shortening shelf life.



Tomato sauce

Preserved by: home canned

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

TOMATO SAUCE

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned



up to 12 months canned in a cool, dark place

Wow: Home canned tomato sauce can last up to a year, much longer than fresh sauce in the fridge.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place; inspect jars before use for spoilage signs.



Lemon curd

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

LEMON CURD

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water bath)



3-4 months canned, or up to 1 year frozen

Wow: Canned lemon curd lasts only a few months, but frozen curd keeps quality up to a year.

Safety: Discard any lemon curd showing browning or separation; freeze promptly after cooling for extended storage.



Smoked Seafood

Preserved by: refrigerated, smoked

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

SMOKED SEAFOOD

FRESH



1-3 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED — refrigerated, smoked



2-3 weeks refrigerated smoked

Wow: Smoked seafood lasts only a few weeks refrigerated, much shorter than frozen seafood, despite the smoking process.

Safety: Smoked seafood is perishable and should not be refrigerated longer than 2-3 weeks; freezing is recommended for longer storage.



Peaches

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PEACHES

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12-18 months home canned

Wow: Fresh peaches last only days refrigerated, but canned peaches can keep best quality for over a year.

Safety: Store home canned peaches in a cool, dark place; exposure to heat or light reduces quality and shelf life.

Elderberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned high-sugar jam

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

ELDERBERRY JAM

FRESH



1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned high-sugar jam



12 months home canned

Wow: Elderberry jam must have a high sugar ratio to be safe when canned; the sugar keeps bad bacteria from growing.

Safety: Follow exact sugar ratios and processing times when making elderberry jams to prevent botulism risk.



Pears

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PEARS

FRESH



5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12-18 months home canned

Wow: Home canned pears can be stored safely up to 18 months, but fresh pears spoil in under a week even refrigerated.

Safety: Store canned pears in cool, dry conditions away from heat and light for best quality.



Plums

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PLUMS

FRESH



5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12-18 months home canned

Wow: Fresh plums go bad in under a week refrigerated, but canned plums stay good for over a year.

Safety: Keep canned plums away from direct heat or freezing to maintain shelf life and quality.



Berries

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

BERRIES

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12 months home canned

Wow: Though berries are very perishable fresh, canned berries can remain good quality for a full year.

Safety: Store home canned berries in cool, dark, dry conditions to prevent spoilage and quality loss.



Fresh tomatoes

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FRESH TOMATOES

FRESH



about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (pressure canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Home canned tomatoes last over a year, vastly outlasting their fresh refrigerated life.

Safety: Use tested recipes and process tomato products in a pressure canner at recommended pressures and times.



Fresh salsa (homemade refrigerator)

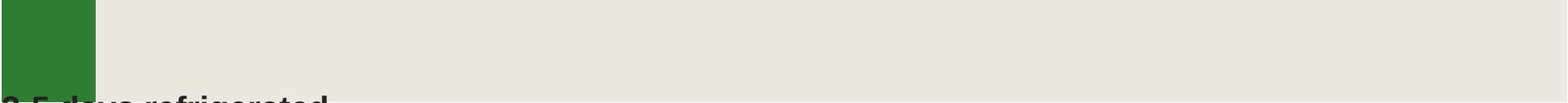
Preserved by: home canned salsa (boiling water canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FRESH SALSA (HOMEMADE REFRIGERATOR)

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned salsa (boiling water canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Though fresh salsa spoils in days, the same ingredients canned properly last over a year safely.

Safety: Boiling water canning with tested recipes is critical; process times depend on altitude and acidity.



Spaghetti sauce without meat

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

SPAGHETTI SAUCE WITHOUT MEAT

FRESH



about 5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (pressure canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Canned spaghetti sauce made without meat keeps safely over a year, much longer than fresh sauce in the fridge.

Safety: Do not increase proportion of low acid vegetables; process in a pressure canner at 20-25 minutes depending on jar size.



Tomato salsa (using paste tomatoes)

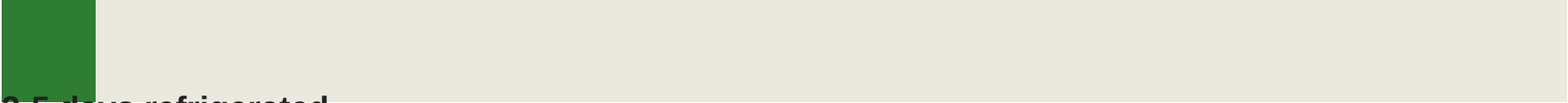
Preserved by: home canned (boiling water canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

TOMATO SALSA (USING PASTE TOMATOES)

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Tomato salsa made with paste tomatoes lasts a few days fresh but over a year canned safely.

Safety: Use tested recipes and vinegar levels; process 15-25 minutes in boiling water canner based on altitude.



Tomatoes with okra or zucchini

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

TOMATOES WITH OKRA OR ZUCCHINI

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (pressure canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Adding okra or zucchini to canned tomatoes does not shorten shelf life if processed properly.

Safety: Process in pressure canner; added vegetables require careful adherence to tested recipes and processing times.



Green Beans

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

GREEN BEANS

FRESH



5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (pressure canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Home-canned green beans last almost 3 years safe, far longer than fresh refrigerated beans last about a week.

Safety: Use pressure canning to destroy Clostridium botulinum spores; boiling water canner is unsafe for low acid vegetables.



Sweet Corn

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

SWEET CORN

FRESH



1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (pressure canner)



12-18 months, home canned

Wow: Fresh sweet corn loses quality within days, but home-canned corn stays good and safe for about 1.5 years.

Safety: Always use pressure canning for corn to prevent botulism; refrigerator storage extends freshness only a few days.



Fresh Peas

Preserved by: frozen

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FRESH PEAS

FRESH



2-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen



8-12 months frozen

Wow: Freezing fresh peas preserves their best quality for almost a year, far longer than just a few days fresh.

Safety: Freeze promptly after blanching for best quality; freezing does not kill all microbes but stops their growth.



Pumpkin (cubed)

Preserved by: frozen

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PUMPKIN (CUBED)

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen



10-12 months frozen

Wow: Cubed pumpkin freezes well for nearly a year, significantly extending its use beyond just a few days fresh.

Safety: Blanch cubes before freezing for best quality; frozen pumpkin remains safe past quality loss if kept frozen.



Garlic

Preserved by: frozen chopped

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

GARLIC

FRESH



1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen chopped



3-6 months frozen

Wow: Fresh garlic can last about a week refrigerated, but freezing chopped garlic keeps its flavor safe up to half a year.

Safety: Use airtight containers or vacuum sealing for freezing to avoid freezer burn; garlic in oil must be refrigerated and used quickly.



Cucumbers (pickled)

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

CUCUMBERS (PICKLED)

FRESH



about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water bath)



up to 1 year stored in a cool, dark, dry place

Wow: Pickled cucumbers can last up to a year, vastly outliving their fresh lifespan of about a week.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place; remove screw bands to prevent rusting; use proper vinegar acidity to prevent bacterial growth.



Bread and Butter Pickles

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

BREAD AND BUTTER PICKLES

FRESH



5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water bath)



up to 1 year in pantry storage

Wow: Bread and Butter Pickles transform fresh zucchini or cucumbers lasting days into a pantry staple lasting a year or more.

Safety: Use proper vinegar concentration and processing times; keep stored away from heat and light to preserve quality.



Pickled Hot Peppers

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PICKLED HOT PEPPERS

FRESH



about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water bath)



up to 1 year shelf stable

Wow: Hot peppers, though fresh for just a week, become shelf stable for up to a year once pickled correctly.

Safety: Wear gloves handling hot peppers; process in boiling water bath according to altitude and jar size to ensure safety.



Fermented Sauerkraut

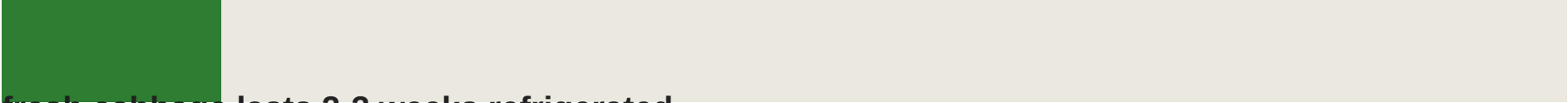
Preserved by: fermentation (brined)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FERMENTED SAUERKRAUT

FRESH



fresh cabbage lasts 2-3 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED — fermentation (brined)



fermented sauerkraut can last for 4-6 months refrigerated

Wow: Fermented sauerkraut lasts many months longer than fresh cabbage thanks to friendly bacteria producing acid.

Safety: Keep sauerkraut submerged in brine during fermentation; store refrigerated to prevent spoilage.



Pickled Onions

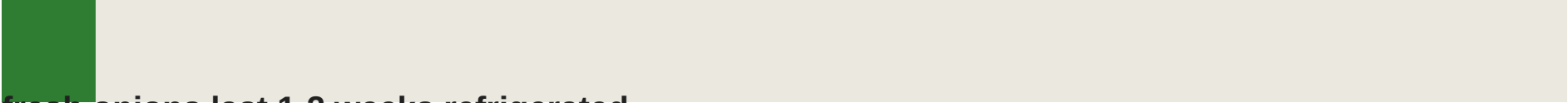
Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

PICKLED ONIONS

FRESH



fresh onions last 1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED — home canned (boiling water bath)



up to 1 year shelf stable

Wow: Pickled onions keep safe and tasty for up to a year, while fresh onions spoil within a couple of weeks.

Safety: Use approved pickling recipe with sufficient vinegar; process jars fully to prevent spoilage and botulism risk.



Strawberry Freezer Jam

Preserved by: frozen (freezer)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

STRAWBERRY FREEZER JAM

FRESH



1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen (freezer)



up to 1 year frozen

Wow: Freezing jams preserves both flavor and texture much longer than refrigerating fresh jam, which spoils quickly.

Safety: Freezer jams are not heat processed; must be kept frozen or refrigerated and used within recommended times.



Grape Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

GRAPE JAM

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12-18 months home canned

Wow: Properly canned grape jam can last over a year, far longer than fresh jam which spoils in less than a week.

Safety: Follow exact canning times and headspace recommendations precisely to ensure safety and avoid spoilage.



Blackberry Jelly

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

BLACKBERRY JELLY

FRESH



2-4 days refrigerated fresh juice/jelly

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath)



12-18 months home canned jelly

Wow: Blackberry jelly, when canned properly, can keep safely for over a year, in contrast to fresh juice which spoils in a few days.

Safety: Use only tested recipes and ensure jelly reaches gelling point and process times to maintain safety.



No-Sugar Added Fruit Spread

Preserved by: home canned (water bath, low sugar recipes)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

NO-SUGAR ADDED FRUIT SPREAD

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath, low sugar recipes)



6-12 months home canned low sugar

Wow: Low sugar fruit spreads require careful processing and have a shorter shelf life than traditional jams with high sugar.

Safety: Low sugar spreads need tested recipes and proper acidification to ensure safety during canning.



High-Sugar Elderberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath, high sugar ratio)

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

HIGH-SUGAR ELDERBERRY JAM

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED — home canned (water bath, high sugar ratio)



12-18 months home canned high sugar jam

Wow: Elderberry jams must have very high sugar levels to be safely canned because of their low natural acidity.

Safety: Must strictly follow sugar-to-juice ratios and processing times to prevent risk from botulism.



Fresh Mushrooms

Preserved by: refrigerated

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FRESH MUSHROOMS

FRESH



1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — refrigerated



up to 12 months frozen

Wow: Fresh mushrooms only last a couple days refrigerated, but they can be frozen up to a year for long storage.

Safety: Keep mushrooms dry and store in refrigerator to delay spoilage; freeze if storing long term.



Eggs

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

EGGS

FRESH



3-5 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED — fresh refrigerated



months to years stored in water glass (lime water)

Wow: Storing eggs in water glass can preserve them for many months, far longer than typical refrigeration.

Safety: Commercial eggs are washed and must be refrigerated; improper storage or washing decreases shelf life.



Fresh Fish (Salmon)

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

FRESH FISH (SALMON)

FRESH



1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — fresh refrigerated



up to 3 months frozen

Wow: Fresh salmon spoils fast in the fridge but can keep good quality only up to 3 months frozen.

Safety: Freeze at 0°F or colder; avoid slow freezing to reduce ice crystal damage; cook immediately after thawing.



Cooked Meat Casserole

Preserved by: frozen

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

COOKED MEAT CASSEROLE

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — frozen



4-6 months frozen

Wow: A cooked meat casserole lasts just days in the fridge but can be kept frozen for half a year.

Safety: Freeze promptly in airtight packaging; store at 0°F or lower for best quality.



Acorn squash

Preserved by: frozen

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

ACORN SQUASH

FRESH



1-2 months in cool storage at 50-55°F

PRESERVED — frozen



8-12 months frozen at 0°F

Wow: Acorn squash lasts just 1-2 months fresh in cool storage but can be frozen and retain quality for up to a year.

Safety: Store fresh squash at 50-55°F to avoid rapid deterioration; freezing stops spoilage but quality declines if frozen too long.



Beef Jerky

Preserved by: dried

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

BEEF JERKY

FRESH



1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — dried



1-2 months at room temperature, up to 6 months refrigerated, or 1 year frozen

Wow: Homemade beef jerky can last almost a year if frozen, vastly outlasting fresh meat's brief refrigerated life.

Safety: Store jerky in a cool, dark, dry place; discard if mold appears.



Smoked Sausage

Preserved by: smoked

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

SMOKED SAUSAGE

FRESH



1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED — smoked



2-3 weeks refrigerated vacuum sealed

Wow: Smoking extends sausage shelf life modestly-weeks, not months-so refrigeration remains essential.

Safety: Keep smoked sausage refrigerated and vacuum-sealed for best quality and safety.



Dried Herbs

Preserved by: dried

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

DRIED HERBS

FRESH



1-2 weeks fresh at room temperature

PRESERVED — dried



1-3 years dried in airtight container

Wow: Dry herbs retain flavor and safety for years, while fresh herbs spoil in days.

Safety: Store dried herbs in airtight containers away from light and moisture for best quality.



Smoked Bacon

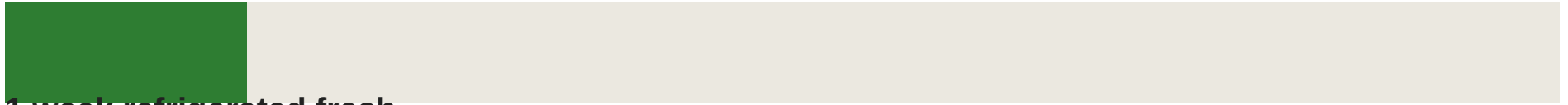
Preserved by: smoked and cured

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

SMOKED BACON

FRESH



1 week refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED — smoked and cured



1-2 months refrigerated smoked and cured

Wow: Smoking combined with curing roughly triples the shelf life of bacon under refrigeration.

Safety: Keep smoked bacon refrigerated and use within recommended time; discard if off odor or slime appear.



Dried Peppers

Preserved by: dried

Make your guess — how long does it last FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Then flip the board for the answer.

DRIED PEPPERS

FRESH



1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED — dried



6 months to 1 year dried in airtight container

Wow: Dried peppers last many months at room temperature, far longer than fresh ones which spoil in weeks.

Safety: Store dried peppers in a cool, dry, dark place in sealed containers to prevent spoilage.